

Company: **General Mills**

Job Profile: **Summer Internship 2025**

Offer Type: Internship Only

Internship Stipend: Rs. 35,000/month

CTC: N/A

Location: Mumbai, Maharashtra, India

Process Date: 14/09/2024

Placement Process:

1. **Online Assessment** [Around 150 candidates appeared for this round]

The online assessment round consisted of 60 questions and had a duration of 1 hour and 10 minutes. There were three sections: logical reasoning, language proficiency, and technical questions.

The aptitude section consisted of 15 basic questions on topics like time-work problems and general math, to be completed in 20 minutes, where balancing speed and accuracy was critical. The language proficiency section consisted of 15 questions in 15 minutes, focusing on grammar, vocabulary, sentence structure, and comprehension. It was straightforward but required quick thinking and good command of the English language to finish within the limited time.

Lastly, the technical section included questions on object-oriented programming, computer networks, operating systems, SQL, and DBMS, emphasizing the importance of having a strong grasp of core computer science concepts.

Out of the 150 that appeared, 18 were shortlisted for the next round.

2. **Technical Interview** [18 candidates appeared for this round]

The technical interview lasted 50 minutes to an hour, focusing heavily on my internship experience and projects, particularly in machine learning and web development. The interviewer began by asking which domain I preferred working in, and I chose machine learning. I was then asked to elaborate on why I found it interesting, followed by detailed questions about my experience in that field. I discussed the machine learning projects I had worked on and the contributions I made during my internship. These discussions led to further cross-questions, testing my in-depth knowledge of the work I had done. It became clear that having a thorough understanding of my projects and past experiences was crucial for this round.

In addition, I was presented with a case study that lacked many details, and I was expected to ask relevant questions to gather more information. This part of the interview aimed to assess my critical thinking, problem-solving skills, and how I approach complex, vague scenarios, especially from a machine learning perspective. I had to explain my thought process and steps I would take to tackle the problem.

The technical portion covered a range of topics: I was questioned about database choices, including the rationale behind selecting certain types and the differences between them. I discussed machine learning algorithms I had used, the reasons for choosing them, and the insights gained from their results. The interview also included specific SQL questions, and I was asked about neural networks—such as their different types, applications, and why they are used in particular scenarios. Additionally, I was asked which programming languages I used most frequently and received questions specific to those languages. The interviewer inquired about my favorite college subjects, with both theoretical and practical questions aimed at gauging my depth of understanding.

Overall, the interview was smooth but had tricky moments, particularly when delving into complex technical details. Having a strong grasp of my fundamentals, being well-versed in everything on my resume, and being able to clearly articulate my thought process helped me navigate the questions confidently.

Out of the 18 that appeared, 10 were shortlisted for the next round.

3. **HR Interview** [10 candidates appeared for this round]

In my HR round, I was primarily asked personal questions, with a focus on my interests and experiences outside of academics. One of the more unique questions was when they asked me to "sell" General Mills to them, which tested my knowledge of the company and the research I had done beforehand. There was also considerable attention on the committees and extracurricular activities I had been part of over the past two years, and they asked me to discuss both the positive and negative aspects of these experiences.

They were curious about my interests beyond my degree, and I was asked what I enjoy doing that isn't related to academics. They also inquired about my future aspirations, asking where I see myself when I'm 35 or 40. Another question focused on my reading habits, asking about the most recent book I had read and to discuss it. Additionally, I was asked how my friends perceive me, both in terms of strengths and weaknesses. Overall, it was a smooth and comfortable round where the main focus was on being authentic and honest in my responses.

Out of the 10 that appeared in the last round, 4 candidates were selected.

Useful Tips:

To succeed in this selection process, focus on your core computer science fundamentals such as computer networks, object-oriented programming, operating systems, SQL, and aptitude. These areas are crucial to clearing the online assessment round.

For the technical interviews, ensure that you know your projects and internships thoroughly. Be prepared to discuss your contributions, the tech stack you used, and your reasoning behind specific choices. SQL and DBMS will often be revisited, so make sure to revise those topics, along with basic data structures and algorithms (DSA). It's important to be confident but also take your time to think through the questions before answering.

When it comes to the HR round, honesty, clarity, and genuineness go a long way. Research the company extensively before the interview so you're ready to talk about it, and make sure you're prepared to discuss your interests outside of academics. This will help you navigate the more personal questions.